

1

Preparation

How to prepare for your Professional Growth Meeting

Annual professional growth conversations will always be held during directed time. PPA time should not routinely be used for professional growth conversation though can be with the agreement between you and your line manager.

You should attend your professional growth conversation having reflected on the goal(s) you would like to set for this upcoming academic year.

If you have concerns about the professional growth process or conversation, you should discuss this with the senior leader who manages your department or area of the Trust.

Personal Reflection

When reflecting and preparing for your Professional Growth meeting, it would be helpful for you to consider the following:

Reflecting on your teaching

Identify successful aspects of your teaching. What strategies have worked effectively? How do you know?

Consider any challenges you have encountered. Are there any obstacles or areas where a different focus/ improvement is needed?

Have there been any changes in my personal/ departmental/ school context within the past year that have impacted my teaching?

How do you feel your expertise has grown in the last year? How did this growing expertise contribute to you working towards your goals for 2024-2025?

Reflecting on the impact of your professional learning on your pupils

During the past year, how has your teaching practice changed due to any professional development you have undertaken?

What impact do you feel that you have had in the last academic year in supporting your department/ wider school to achieve its goals?

How has your professional learning impacted the pupils you teach? How do you know?

Considering your next steps

Think about any whole-school priorities/ departmental priorities that are a focus for your school. Which areas are worthy of further exploration to help support you in your growing expertise and help you to further contribute to strategic development?

Which aspects of teaching and learning do you feel you would like to develop further, to support your students, the department and even the wider school?

Are there any opportunities in the Trust's CPD brochure that you feel you could use to further your learning and development?

If you are a...	You will...
Teachers (Main Pay Scale and Upper Pay Range)	• Identify one professional goal linked to your role within school as part of your professional growth plan. • Have opportunity to identify your career aspirations and goals and be supported to explore and achieve these.
TLR Holders	• Identify two professional goals- one professional goal linked to your role within school as part of your professional growth plan and one professional goal linked to your area of leadership. • Have the opportunity to identify your career goals and aspirations and be supported to explore and achieve these.



During the Meeting

What to expect during your Professional Growth meeting

The Professional Growth conversation will:

- Be **fair and equitable** to all providing equal opportunities for development regardless of your role, career stage or age.
- Embody our value of being candid through a process which values **giving and receiving honest and reflective feedback**.
- Encourage you and your line manager to be **courageous** through our ambition for all our staff by a process of setting of goals without the constraint of pay progression as the fundamental driver and therefore **be grounded in the principle of innovation and improvement**.
- Show **we are accountable** for our own development which is linked with the **professional integrity to grow and improve**.
- Provide a process which embodies the Blueprint professional behaviours described in our work, our development and our approach.

Your meeting will be made up of **two parts**. Firstly, you will have the opportunity to reflect on your learning during the previous year, and then you will have the opportunity to discuss and set your professional goal(s) for this academic year.

Part 1: Reflection

Firstly...

Reflect positively, recognising the ways you are meeting the expectations of your role and wider professional contribution. Reflect on your goals from last academic year- how has your learning made a difference?

Secondly...

Reflect on the context within which you are working and the challenges you are seeking to address.

Then...

There is an opportunity to identify ways your role is linking with the strategic aims of your school/ our Trust.



Part 2: Identification of Professional Goals

Firstly...

Devise a goal(s) within your professional context that identifies your unique contribution to a team/school priority which allows for innovative and pioneering approaches .

Remember...

The goal(s) should align with the strategic direction of our Trust, school or department

Finally...

You will have the opportunity to identify career aspirations and goals and be supported to achieve these.

During the meeting, spend some time with your line manager crafting an effective professional goal before you upload your professional goal onto the MS Form.